

DANCE

OVERVIEW

In dance courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level, students continue to learn in, about, and through dance. The medium of expression is movement; the instrument is the human body. Dance education goes beyond the study of a repertoire of movements to offer an understanding of the principles and concepts that govern and define the art. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences through innovative choreographic insights. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge and skills, and a synergy between intellect, ability, and emotion. Engagement in dance can provide a context for understanding world issues and exploring a variety of cultures. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students refine their kinesthetic awareness and use all of the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, relationship) to create dance works that explore themes and express ideas and moods. Technique emphasizes the importance of physiological and safety factors while leading to a fuller use of the body and all its parts, stimulating creative and expressive abilities. Students use the elements of movement with increasing refinement, complexity, and variety. They also give attention to development of alignment, balance, correct breathing, flexibility, and strength in creating dance works and performing them safely.

The art of dance should be shared. Students develop performance skills through formal and informal presentations, helping them recognize and communicate both aesthetic and personal values. They learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product. Students also demonstrate an increased understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods. They refine their ability to evaluate the quality of performances by critiquing their own and others' work.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the refinement of abilities, skills, and competencies. Students demonstrate increased autonomy and innovation in their practice as both choreographer and dancer. They develop personal metaphor and demonstrate their depth of understanding of the creative process. They become increasingly familiar with the tools of stagecraft in dance presentations.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) involves applying rational and logical thinking to learning in, about, and through dance. Students demonstrate increasing autonomy and ability of all stages of the critical analysis process. They evaluate their own dance work and the work of others, reflect on how dance can enhance both personal well-being and community life, investigate artistic and social influences on dance, and explore possibilities for continuing engagement in dance.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, understanding, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Understanding how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary helps students develop insight into how and why people dance. Students examine developments in dance history and dance conventions around the world. At the same time, they expand their awareness of the artistic environment with respect to matters of safety, ethics, and acceptable modes of conduct as an artist, performer, and critic.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 11

University/College Preparation

ATC3M

This course emphasizes the development of students' artistry, improvisational and compositional skills, and technical proficiency in dance genres from around the world. Students will apply dance elements, techniques, and tools in a variety of ways, including performance situations; describe and model responsible practices related to the dance environment; and reflect on how the study of dance affects personal and artistic development.

Prerequisite: Dance, Grade 9 or 10, Open

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to create and perform increasingly complex dance phrases inspired by a theme (*e.g., use drawing or writing to depict a theme evoked by a piece of instrumental music, then translate the theme into a series of dance phrases; use free writing to identify themes of interest to them, and create a series of movement phrases based on key words or descriptions from their writing*)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of the music did you focus on in your writing or drawing? What elements of dance will you focus on in translating these aspects into movement phrases?”

- A1.2** create and perform increasingly complex phrases that combine and manipulate the elements of dance in a variety of ways (*e.g., include one or more of compound time, repetition, retrograde, or canon in a movement study; develop three or more balances and create simple, organic, connective movements to move from balance to balance*)

Teacher prompt: “Which element will you focus on first when trying to create movement phrases that meet several different criteria?”

- A1.3** use the elements of dance to generate and perform increasingly complex dance vocabulary through improvisation and experimentation with a partner or in a group (*e.g., use contact improvisation to develop movement with a partner, with attention to considerations such as trust, the sharing of weight, and non-verbal communication*)

Teacher prompt: “In working with a partner, how do you maintain balance as you pull away from each other? What movement is generated while getting into and out of this balance?”

- A1.4** develop solutions to increasingly complex compositional problems, and demonstrate selected solutions through performance (*e.g., use motif in the creation of solos, duets, and trios; use variations on a theme within different configurations; demonstrate various ways of making smooth transitions between different configurations; develop movement phrases that reflect the dancers’ relationship to one another and to the dance environment*)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways are movement motifs similar to narrative themes found in a literary source? How could using a motif help you express your ideas?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 use a variety of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques to create and perform increasingly complex dance works (*e.g., working in trios, develop a solo for each dancer, including a movement motif that connects each solo; have the solos performed simultaneously to create multiple foci; then use unison performance of the movement motif to create a theme and variation structure*)

Teacher prompt: “What challenges does a multi-focus work present to an audience? What choreographic structures or techniques could you use to help the viewer understand what is going on?”

A2.2 create a complex dance composition that explores a self- or teacher-selected theme (*e.g., develop a dance interpretation of a theme suggested by the film *Hula Girls* by Sang-il Lee*)

Teacher prompt: “What dance structures could you use to communicate your theme? How could you use the elements to vary the structures to create interest?”

A2.3 use a variety of compositional approaches to express a broad range of ideas and moods through dance (*e.g., determine which of two compositional approaches offers more scope for communicating a particular message or theme through dance*)

Teacher prompt: “What factors do you need to consider when deciding on the most appropriate compositional approach for a particular dance project?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 apply an understanding of the principal movements of a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., accurately perform key movements from ballet or jazz dance, modern/contemporary dance, and two or more world dance forms such as Afro-Caribbean dance, salsa, and the hula*)

Teacher prompt: “How does your knowledge of different movement vocabularies help you learn new dance forms more easily? What similarities do different forms share that help you transfer your body knowledge from one form to the next?”

A3.2 accurately reproduce a range of dynamics and movement techniques from a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., correctly perform a given phrase that contains fall, swing, and suspension*)

Teacher prompt: “How is momentum or speed a factor in exploring the dynamics of this phrase? For each movement quality, what is the relationship of the body to gravity?”

A3.3 create and perform compositions that blend the vocabulary and technique of two or more dance forms from around the world (*e.g., flamenco and belly dancing*)

Teacher prompt: “How can you use the similarities between these two forms to make the movements appear to flow seamlessly back and forth between the forms?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 revise, refine, and polish movement execution and choreography with increased attention to detail (*e.g., use their own perceptions and feedback from peers and the teacher to identify problems, rework choreography, and refine their technical execution of movements, timing, spacing, and interactions*)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of your dance are you not satisfied with? What specific things do you think you need to improve?”

A4.2 use the tools of stagecraft with increasing creativity to enhance their dance performances (*e.g., heighten the appeal to the senses by introducing incense, background sound, lighting effects, and herbal tea, and by having the audience walk into the space barefoot on bubble wrap*)

Teacher prompt: “What changes could you make to the performance environment that might encourage a positive audience response to your presentation?”

A4.3 apply an understanding of the artistic and expressive intent of a work when rehearsing and performing (*e.g., pay attention to what their bodies are doing individually and in relation to other dancers; maintain awareness of the connection between their movements and the mood or theme of a piece*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important for you to understand the intended meaning or effect of a dance you are performing?” “What can you do to prepare yourself mentally for a dance performance?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to compare and contrast two Canadian choreographic works (e.g., *describe the stylistic difference in the choreography of Allen Kaeja's Asylum of Spoons and Ginette Laurin's Luna*)

Teacher prompt: "How would you define contemporary dance? Why do you think there is so much variety in this one dance form?"

- B1.2** develop and use aesthetic criteria to evaluate both the content and the fluency or expressiveness of student compositions (e.g., *criteria including but not limited to: variety of compositional structures, clarity of intent, suitability of movement choices to purpose or theme, smoothness of transitions, connection between movement and musical mood and phrasing*)

Teacher prompts: "What do you look for in a dance when judging the movements and movement patterns? Their variety and/or complexity? The way they are combined? What other qualities?" "What questions do you ask about how level, shape or direction, and rhythm have been used? About the handling of transitions between sequences or sections? About the connections between the music, the movements, and the theme or purpose?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify some world and social dance forms that have been introduced in Canada and explain their growing influence or popularity (e.g., *the African dance of Zab Maboungou and Le cercle d'expression artistique Nyata Nyata*)

Teacher prompt: "Why might a range of dance forms from around the world attract interest in Canada? What examples can you find?"

- B2.2** explain how dance education contributes to their personal growth and well-being (e.g., *develop ten "Dance education gives me..." statements that reflect how they benefit from studying dance*)

Teacher prompt: "How could listing the benefits of dance education contribute to your learning in dance?"

- B2.3** explain how the culture of different societies fostered the development of specific dances or dance types (e.g., *the "twist" in mid-twentieth-century North America, the quadrille in eighteenth-century France*)

Teacher prompt: "What kinds of trends in popular culture have been linked to the emergence of new forms of social dance?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify a variety of career options that are available in the dance arts and the skills required for each (*e.g., dancer, choreographer, instructor, set/costume/lighting designer, publicist, production manager, dance reviewer*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some careers in the dance arts that support performers?” “How many people are required to work on a professional dance show and what are their duties?”

- B3.2** develop and implement a plan to promote dance education in their school community (*e.g., research how dance courses at their school are viewed by other arts students, the general school community, and teachers and administrators; brainstorm ways to raise awareness of the benefits and importance of dance arts for individuals and communities*)

Teacher prompt: “What can you do to find out how the dance arts are perceived at your school? How would you like dance to be understood and treated at your school? What steps could you take to promote your viewpoint?”

- B3.3** develop and maintain a traditional or digital dance portfolio that demonstrates the depth and breadth of their learning (*e.g., record analyses of or reflections on challenges they faced, how they responded to them, and what they learned from them*)

Teacher prompt: “How have your dance skills changed or developed since you created your first portfolio? What moments or works do you remember most clearly? What made them particularly memorable or meaningful?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social, cultural, and historical origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and describe alternative physical practices that enhance dance training and physical well-being (e.g., karate, aikido, ju-jitsu, t'ai chi)
Teacher prompt: "Describe the relationship between the Brazilian martial art of capoeira and the dance form of the same name. What connections can you make between the 'ginga' movement and modern dance steps that you learn in class? How could developing the strength, groundedness, and acrobatic ability required for capoeira enhance your overall learning in dance?"
- C1.2** use biomechanical terminology to describe movement (e.g., demonstrate and name the movements that represent flexion/extension, internal/external rotation, inversion/eversion)
Teacher prompts: "How would you describe the Pilates exercises 'hundreds' and 'the saw' using biomechanical terms?" "How does understanding biomechanics and how the body moves help you to use self-correction and peer feedback to improve your technique?"
- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, the principal dance vocabulary of a variety of dance forms from around the world (e.g., describe and perform Latin dances such as salsa, samba, meringue, rhumba; develop an instructional DVD to explain a world dance

form to novice dancers, share the DVD with the class, and ask for peer feedback on the effectiveness of their instruction)

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of key developments in Canadian dance history, including the artistic contributions of Canadian dance pioneers (e.g., the founding and development of dance companies such as the Royal Winnipeg Ballet or Decidedly Jazz Danceworks; the work of dancer-choreographers such as Carol Anderson or Robert Desrosiers)
Teacher prompts: "What were the goals of the founders of the dance company? What challenges did they face in establishing the company in Canada? Are there other companies like this in Canada?" "Who were the key artists who founded Dancemakers, and what were their goals? How have the company and its work evolved since its founding?"
- C2.2** describe how artistic, social, political, and environmental events have influenced the evolution of local and global dance communities (e.g., research and report on the effects of migration, globalization, or art trends on the dance community in Canada, or on the development of modern dance as a vehicle for social commentary)
Teacher prompt: "How does dance compare to drama and music as an effective way to comment on environmental issues such as pollution or global warming?"

C2.3 identify ways in which dance genres they have studied have challenged social or cultural stereotypes or boundaries in the arts (e.g., *describe the dance legacy of José Limón as a response to the limitations of visual art*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some examples of dance or types of dance that challenge viewers’ ideas about age or race or gender?” “What are some types of dance that challenge stereotypes about who can perform or participate in dance?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 demonstrate responsible, constructive behaviour in interactions with others during the creation and production processes (e.g., *work cooperatively to solve problems and resolve conflicts peacefully; show respect for others’ views in open forum discussions about performances or presentations by class members; use the phrase “I saw” in place of “I like”*)

Teacher prompt: “Why is it important to keep value judgements out of your comments by beginning statements with ‘I saw’?”

C3.2 identify and carry out the responsibilities of the varied roles they undertake during dance activities (e.g., *responsibilities of a choreographer, costume manager, dancer, props or materials manager, rehearsal director, sound technician*)

Teacher prompt: “What steps can you take to ensure that each group member understands the requirements of his or her role? What might be the benefits of agreeing in advance on a procedure to check that essential tasks are being completed adequately and on time? What might such a tracking mechanism look like?”

C3.3 identify and follow safe and ethical practices in dance activities in both classroom and performance settings (e.g., *learn and apply procedures for the safe use of equipment in studios, classrooms, and rehearsal and performance spaces; comply with laws, regulations, and customary practices for the protection of choreographic, creative, and intellectual property rights*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some hazards related to equipment use we need to be aware of during dance activities? What physical, psychological, or environmental hazards do we need to protect against?” “How does copyright law define and penalize theft of another choreographer’s work?” “How can you include ideas from others’ work yet still make a work your own?”